

BOOSTER

a short film

Blue Sheep Films

working draft v1.1

EXT. BIG-BOX PARKING LOT - NIGHT

Two in the morning, and a parking lot the size of a lake with one car on it.

Under the only working light: a tired sedan, hood up. COLE (26) sits on the bumper in a hoodie, holding his phone up at the sky like an offering. 4% battery. No bars worth having.

He tries the ignition again through the window. The engine makes the sound of a dead thing being asked politely.

COLE
Yeah. No. I know.

He goes back to the bumper. The lot hums. Somewhere a sign buzzes ONE HOUR PHOTO at a world that has not needed one hour photo in twenty years.

MAIN TITLE: BOOSTER

EXT. BIG-BOX PARKING LOT - LATER

Headlights. A pickup truck, older than Cole, rolls into the lot – slows – and swings around, nose to nose with the sedan, the way people who know what they're doing park for this.

JUNE (48) gets out. Scrubs under an open flannel. The specific tiredness of a person coming off a twelve-hour shift, which is different from every other tiredness and looks it.

JUNE
Dead?

COLE
Very.

JUNE
Lights? Radio?

COLE
I maybe sat here with the radio on for – a while.

JUNE
(opening her toolbox)
A while.

COLE
An amount of time.

She pulls out jumper cables. Good ones, heavy, coiled right. Not glovebox cables. Owned cables.

JUNE
Pop your terminal covers. Red's probably under the fuse box on these.

COLE
You've done this before.

JUNE
Once or twice.

EXT. BIG-BOX PARKING LOT - MOMENTS LATER

Clamps on. Her truck idling. The two vehicles joined like patients sharing a line.

JUNE
Okay. Now we wait. Ten minutes, let yours drink a bit, or it'll die at the first stoplight and you'll be doing this again with somebody worse than me.

COLE
Ten minutes.

JUNE
Ten minutes.

She lowers her tailgate and sits on it. After a second of nowhere else to be, Cole hops up next to her. The two of them and the idling truck and the lake of empty asphalt.

JUNE (CONT'D)
So what's the story?

COLE
No story. Battery died.

JUNE
It's two in the morning in the parking lot of a closed Walmart. Everybody here has a story. I'm on hour thirteen of mine.

Cole looks at the scrubs.

COLE
Nurse?

JUNE
Emerg. You?

COLE
(beat)
I drive around at night sometimes.
That's the whole thing. I just —
drive until I'm nowhere, and then
I sit in the nowhere for a bit,
and then I go home. Usually the
car participates.

June nods slowly. Not judging. Filing.

JUNE
What are you when you're at home?

COLE
Between things.

JUNE
Between what and what?

COLE
(the honest answer)
That's what I drive around trying
to figure out.

EXT. BIG-BOX PARKING LOT - LATER

The cables hum. Somewhere in the dark the parking lot lights
click through their cycle, one going off, another coming on,
like a slow thought.

JUNE
You know what we call you at work?
People like you, two a.m., nothing
visibly wrong?

COLE
There's a name for me?

JUNE
Walkie-talkies. You walk in
yourself, you talk in sentences.
Whatever's wrong, it isn't
tonight's problem. Triage-wise
you're a green tag. You'll live.

COLE
That's the nicest thing anyone's
said to me in months, which is
probably worth mentioning to
someone.

JUNE

Mention it to the person you drive
around instead of calling.

Cole looks at her. Caught. She shrugs – an emerg shrug, a
we-see-everything shrug – and checks her watch.

COLE

It's my dad. We don't fight, even.
That's the thing. There's nothing
to fix. We just don't – the phone
works both ways and nobody uses
it. It's been a year and a half of
both of us winning.

JUNE

Winning what?

COLE

(beat)

Yeah.

The sign buzzes. ONE HOUR PHOTO. June follows his eyes to
it.

JUNE

My husband used to say those signs
outlive the stores out of spite.

COLE

Used to?

June checks the cables instead of answering. Wiggles a
clamp that didn't need wiggling.

EXT. BIG-BOX PARKING LOT - LATER

She's back on the tailgate. When she talks now it's to the
asphalt, which is easier.

JUNE

Gord. Two years in March. His
truck's still in the garage –
this truck's mine, his is the good
one, the '09, he babied it.

(beat)

A battery dies if you let a truck
sit. So every Sunday I go out and
I start it. Let it run fifteen
minutes. Radio on, his station,
door open so the garage doesn't
fill up. Two years of Sundays,
keeping a battery alive for a
truck nobody drives.

COLE
You could sell it.

JUNE
I could sell it.

The tone says everything about whether she could sell it.

JUNE (CONT'D)
The cables are his. He was the guy
who boosts you. Whole town, any
weather – somebody's kid in a
ditch, Gord's already got his
gloves on. So when I'm driving
home and I see a hood up –
(nods at the sedan)
– I stop. That's it. That's the
whole religion.

Cole takes this in. Twelve hours of other people's worst
nights, and she stopped anyway.

COLE
Hour thirteen.

JUNE
Hour thirteen.

COLE
Thank you.

JUNE
Thank Gord.

EXT. BIG-BOX PARKING LOT - LATER

June checks her watch. Nods at the sedan.

JUNE
Try it.

Cole gets in. Turns the key. The engine catches – rough,
then steady, alive. The dash lights come up like a small
town getting power back.

He should be relieved. He is. But there's the other thing
too, right behind it, and June sees it through the
windshield: it's over now. The ten minutes are up.

He gets out. They unclamp – her order of operations, called
out loud, black off first, like a countdown running
backwards.

She coils the cables right. Of course she coils them right.

COLE
Can I give you—

JUNE
No.

COLE
Gas money, coffee—

JUNE
You can charge your phone. And
when it's charged —
(getting in the truck)
— it works both ways. You said so
yourself.

She pulls the door shut. The window's down.

COLE
Hey — the truck. The '09. Sunday
thing.

(beat)
Fifteen minutes idling isn't
enough, long-term. It needs a real
drive. Half an hour, highway
speed, get the charge up properly.
Otherwise you're just — keeping it
on life support.

June looks at him. Both meanings arrive at the same time,
and she lets them.

JUNE
(finally)
Sunday's a good day for a drive.

COLE
I heard that about Sundays.

EXT. BIG-BOX PARKING LOT - MOMENTS LATER

Two vehicles, engines running, neither moving yet. Both
radios faint through open windows, different stations,
tangled in the middle.

Then her truck eases out, and his sedan follows, and at the
exit of the enormous empty lot they idle side by side at a
red light with no cross-traffic in any direction.

Both of them signal anyway. Opposite ways.

The light goes green. Tail lights separate into the dark,
one going left, one going right, both going home the long
way, probably.

The ONE HOUR PHOTO sign buzzes on over nothing, out of spite, keeping its own battery alive.

CUT TO BLACK.

Over black: a phone, ringing somewhere. Once. Twice. Then, an older man's voice, rough with sleep and something else:

DAD (V.O.)
Cole?

CUT TO SILENCE.

THE END